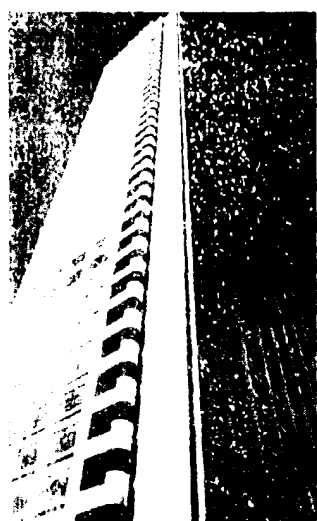




Robert Campbell, medalist



Harbor Towers, looking up

ARCHITECTURE/ROBERT CAMPBELL

A medal for Pei

Ieoh Ming Pei, who has done more than any other single architect to shape the form of Boston in the last two decades, has been selected to receive the Gold Medal of the American Institute of Architects.

The Gold Medal, the AIA's highest award, is given not for any one building but for overall career achievement, and can go to an architect from any part of the world. Last year's Medalist was Philip Johnson. Other winners in the past decade include Richard Neutra, Pietro Belluschi, Louis Kahn, Buckminster Fuller, William Wurster and Marcel Breuer.

Pei's office is in New York, but he has long been associated with Massachusetts. He received his Bachelor of Architecture degree from MIT in 1940 and his Master's from Harvard in 1946, and is currently a member of the MIT Corporation, the Institute's governing body.

Boston contains many more notable works by Pei and his partners than any other city. Among them are the master plan for Government Center; the John Hancock Tower; the Christian Science Center; the Kennedy Presidential Library, now under construction; Harbor Towers; the Green Earth Sciences Building and other buildings at MIT; and a forthcoming major addition to the Boston Museum of Fine Arts. Recently, Pei served as chairman of the jury in a competition for a new Provincetown Playhouse.

This year, Pei's East Building for the National Gallery of Art in Washington brought him a degree of media attention almost unprecedented for an architect. Taking 10 years to build, at an announced cost of more the \$150 per square foot, it was probably the most lavish new American building since before World War II.

Other notable Pei works include the Dallas City Hall, Society Hill towers in

Philadelphia, Everson Museum of Art in Syracuse, and the National Center for Atmospheric Research in Boulder, Colo.

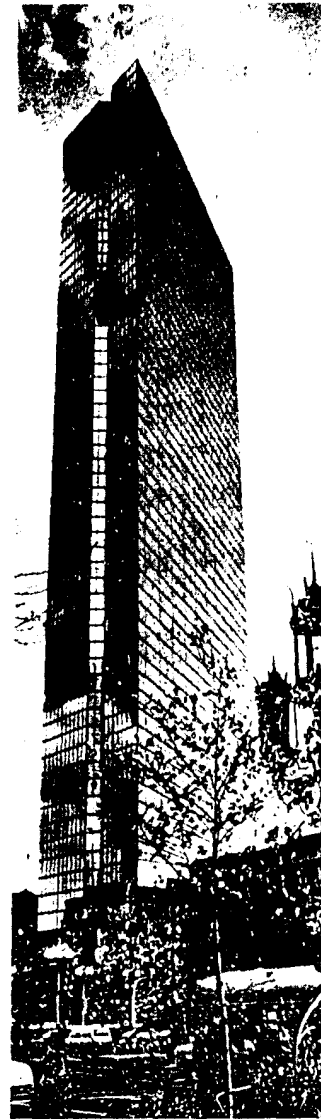
Pei was born in Canton, China, in 1917 and came to the United States as a student in 1935. Before starting his own firm he was house architect to the flamboyant New York real estate king William Zeckendorf, for whom Pei designed the trend-setting Place Ville Marie in Montreal.

In recent years, Pei's firm, I. M. Pei and Partners, has achieved a success and prominence that has perhaps not been matched by a US firm since the heyday of McKim, Mead and White, designers of the Boston Public Library, at the turn of the century. Pei has become something close to an official national architect, the first to be considered for prominent public buildings.

The firm's fortunes were damaged in the early 1970s by the heavily publicized breakage of the Hancock Tower windows, the cause of which is still not certainly established pending various legal actions. Controversy also surrounded such projects as the Christian Science Center, which forced the relocation of many residents and businesses in the Fenway area, and the Kennedy Library, which was driven to abandon its proposed site at Harvard by opponents who claimed it would create too much congestion.

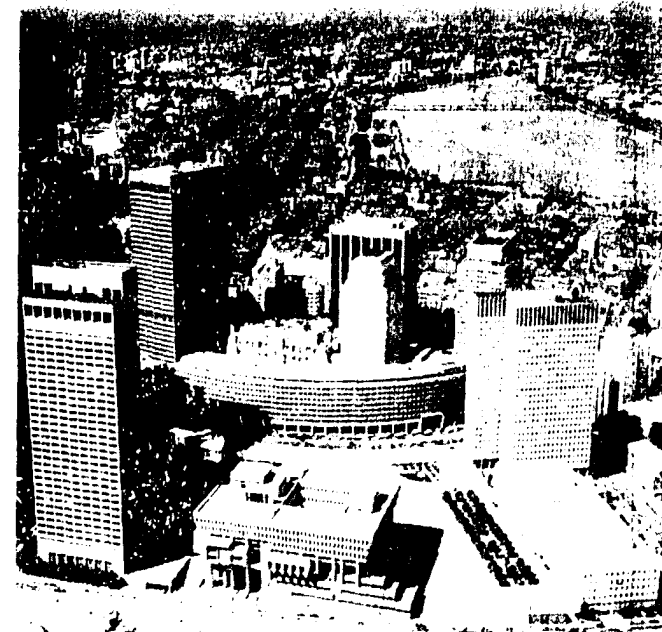
In the architectural community, Pei is seen as a middlebrow, design-oriented modern architect, neither avant-garde nor conservative. He is deeply interested in the sculptural qualities of architecture and in using them to create a sense of monumentality and grandeur. He is also tremendously interested in formal, geometric effects, especially those involving triangles and diagonals in the floor plan, and avoids clutter of any kind even to the point of letting his buildings look bare.

Pei designs much of his firm's work himself, including the East Building in Washington, but also leaves many major

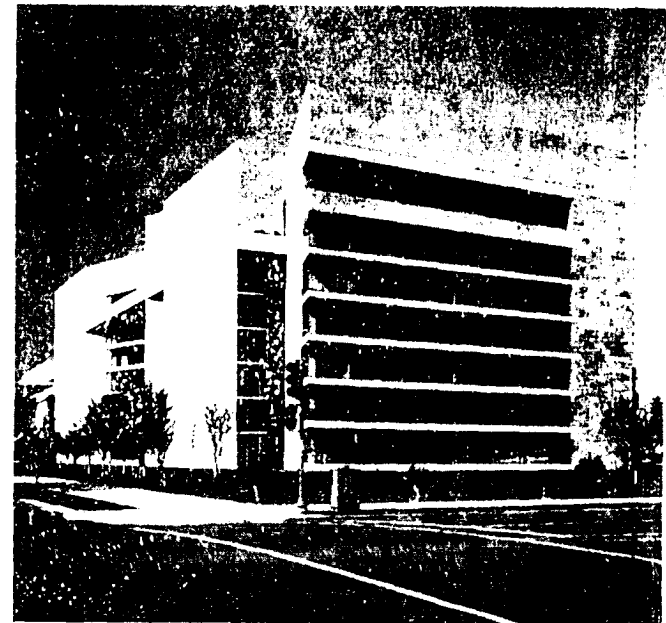


Hancock Tower

projects to partners, including the Hancock Tower (Harry Cobb) and the Christian Science Center (Araldo Cossutta)



Government Center, Boston



National Gallery of Art, Washington, D.C.

Pei's personal charm, and his masterly presentations to clients, are quite literally legendary.

The Gold Medal will be tendered officially in June at the AIA national convention in Kansas City.